

Jezrahiah their ouerfeer.

43 Also that day they offered great sacrifices, and reioyced: for God had made them reioyce with great ioy: the wiues also and the children reioyced: so that the ioy of Ierusalem was heard euen as farre off.

44 ¶ And at that time were some appointed ouer the chambers for the treasures, for the offerings, for the first fruits, and for the tithes, to gather into them out of the fields of the cities the portions of the law for the priests and Levites: for Iudah reioyced for the priests, and for the Levites that waited.

45 And both the fingers and the porters kept the ward of their God, and the ward of the purification, according to the commandement of Dauid, and of Solomon his sonne.

46 For in the dayes of Dauid, and Asaph of old, there were chiefe of the fingers, and songs of praise and thanksgiving vnto God.

47 And all Israel in the dayes of Zerubbabel, and in the dayes of Nehemiah, gaue the portions of the fingers, and the porters, euery day his portion, and they sanctified holy things vnto the Levites, and the Levites sanctified them vnto the children of Aaron.

CHAP. XIII.

1 Vpon the reading of the Law, separation is made from the mixed multitude. 4 Nehemiah at his returne, causeth the chambers to bee cleansed. 10 He reformeth the offices in the house of God. 15 The violation of the Sabbath, 23 & the mariages with strange wiues.

¶ That day they read in the booke of Moyses in the audience of the people, and therein was found written, that the Ammonite and the Moabite should not come into the Congregation of God for ever, because they met not the children of Israel with bread, and with water, but hired Balaam against them, that he should curse them: howbeit our God turned the curse into a blessing.

3 Now it came to passe when they had heard the law, that they separated from Israel all the mixed multitude.

4 ¶ And before this Elishah the priest hauing the ouersight of the chamber of the house of our God, was allied vnto Tobiah:

5 And hee had prepared for him a great chamber, where aforetime they laid the meat offerings, the frankincense and the vessels, and the tithes of the corne, the new wine, and the oyle, which was commanded to be giuen to the Levites, and the fingers, and the porters, and the offerings of the priests.

6 But in all this time was not I at Ierusalem: for in the two and thirtieth yeere of Artaxerxes king of Babylon, came I vnto the king, and after certaine dayes, obtained I leaue of the King:

7 And I came to Ierusalem, and vnderstood of the euil that Elishah did for Tobiah, in preparing him a chamber in the courts of the house of God.

8 And it grieved me sore, therefore I cast forth all the household stuffe of Tobiah out of the chamber:

9 Then I commanded, and they cleansed the chambers, and thither brought I againe the vessels of the house of God, with the meate offering, and the frankincense.

10 ¶ And I perceiued that the portions of the Levites had not bene giuen them: for the Levites and the fingers that did the worke, were fled euery one to his field.

11 Then contended I with the rulers, and said, why is the house of God forsaken: And I gathered them together, and set them in their place.

12 Then brought all Iudah the tithe of the corne, and the new wine, and the oyle, vnto the treasures.

13 And I made treasurers ouer the treasures, Shelemiah the priest, and Zadok the scribe, and of the Levites, Bedaiah: and next to them was Hanan the sonne of Zaccur, the sonne of Nataniah: for they were counted faithfull, and their office was to distribute vnto their brethren.

14 ¶ Remember me, O my God, concerning this, and wipe not out my good deeds, that I haue done for the house of my God, and for the offices thereof.

15 ¶ In those dayes saue I in Iudah, some treading wine presses on the Sabbath, and bringing in sheaves, and lading asses, as also wine, grapes, and figs, and all manner of burdens, which they brought into Ierusalem on the Sabbath day: and I testified against them in the day wherein they solde butials.

† Hebr. she
commande-
ment of the
Leuites.

† Heb. at the
end of daies
|| Or, I ear-
nestly reque-
sted.

† Heb. stand-
ing.

|| Or, store-
houses.

† Hebr. at
their hand.

† Heb. it was
upon them.

* Verſe 22.

† Heb. kind-
ness.
|| Or, obser-
uations.

|| That is, ap-
pointed by
the law.
† Hebr. for
the ioy of
Iudah.
† Heb. that
stood.
1. Chron.
24. and 25.
chap.
* 1. Chron.
25. 1. &c.

|| That is, set
apart.
* Num. 18.
26.

† Heb. there
was read.
* Num. 22.
5. deut. 23. 3
† Heb. eares

* Num. 22.
5. 10. 24. 9

† Heb. being
set ouer.